

The ControlFlag's pattern anomaly detection system can be used for various problems such as typographical error detection, and flagging a missing NULL check, to name a few.

It follows two main phases: (1) pattern mining phase, and (2) scanning for anomalous patterns phase. The pattern mining phase is a 'training phase' that mines typical patterns in the user-provided GitHub repositories and then builds a decision-tree from the mined patterns. The scanning phase, on the other hand, applies the mined patterns to flag anomalous expressions in the user-specified target repositories.

Intel said that since its introduction, ControlFlag has been tested on production-level software and widely used open source software systems. For example, last year, ControlFlag identified a code anomaly in Client URL (cURL), a computer software project transferring data using various network protocols over one billion times a day. The anomaly was reported to the cURL team; it agreed with ControlFlag's findings and subsequently patched its code.

While ControlFlag cannot yet automatically mitigate the effects it finds, it offers users suggestions for potential corrections.

L0phtCrack password auditing tool is now open source

L0phtCrack, the Windows system password auditing tool, has been released as an open source utility.

Christien Rioux (DilDog), one of the original authors of L0phtCrack, had announced plans to release an open source version of the tool in early August on Twitter.

First released in 1997, L0phtCrack can be used to test password strength and recover lost Windows passwords via dictionary, brute-force, and other types of attacks.

It was developed originally by Peiter Zatko. L0pht then merged with @stake, which was acquired by Symantec in 2004. It was owned by Symantec between 2004 and 2009,



when it was acquired from the cybersecurity firm by Zatko and other original authors. By that time, Symantec had stopped selling the tool, according to sources.

In July 1, 2021, the company said L0phtCrack software was no longer owned by Terahash, LLC. It had been repossessed by the previous owners, formerly known as L0pht Holdings, LLC.

L0phtCrack is no longer being sold. The current owners have no plans to sell licences or support subscriptions for the L0phtCrack software. However on October 17, they officially announced the open source availability of L0phtCrack version 7.2.0. The open sourced project is looking for both maintainers and contributors.

Sentry's FOSS Fund 155 to financially support open source community

Sentry, an open source company, announced it has donated US\$ 154,999.89 to 108 individuals under its FOSS Fund 155. The company has invested in the open source community by donating SaaS credits to open source projects, sponsor conferences and meetups, and contribute patches to upstream projects.

Sentry said the inspiration came from it raising US\$ 10,000 from the FOSS Fund Adopters launched by Indeed. "When Sentry received the investment, it committed to increasing its own financial giving to the open source community."

According to the company, the specific amount was carefully calculated. The tech companies receive approximately US\$ 2,000 of value per engineer on staff. Sentry employs 75 engineers, and the fund comes up to US\$ 150,000 as target budget. The rest is to meet membership fee thresholds and currency conversions.

Microsoft reverses .NET change after open source community outcry

Tech giant Microsoft backed off from the decision to remove a key feature from its upcoming .NET 6 release, after a serious public outcry from the open source community.

Microsoft had reportedly disappointed the .NET open source community by removing a key part of Hot Reload in the upcoming release of .NET 6, a feature that allows developers to modify source code while an app is running and immediately see the results, *The Verge* reported.

It is a feature many had been looking forward to using in Visual Studio Code and across multiple platforms until Microsoft made a controversial last-minute decision to lock it to Visual Studio 2022, which is a paid product that's limited to Windows.

Microsoft has now reversed the change following a backlash, and anger inside the company from many of Microsoft's own employees.



"We made a mistake in executing on our decision and took longer than expected to respond back to the community," said Scott Hunter, director of programme management for .NET.

Microsoft has now approved the community's pull request to re-enable this feature and it will be available in the final version of the .NET 6 SDK.

"We have taken steps to address the issue that some of our OSS community members have experienced," said a Microsoft spokesperson in a statement to *The Verge*. "Hot Reload capability will be in the general availability build of the .NET 6 SDK," the spokesperson added.